

Authors' Note

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hen we started writing this book in December 2016, bitcoin was in the \$700s, ether was in the \$7s, and the aggregate network value of cryptoassets was just north of \$10 billion. Over the ensuing months of writing we watched bitcoin push past \$4,000, while ether crossed \$400, and the aggregate network value of cryptoassets punched through \$100 billion. Cryptoassets went from being esoteric dark web material to mainstream topics of conversation and enthusiasm.

When embarking on our literary journey, we recognized the difficulty in documenting arguably the world's fastest moving markets. These markets can change as much in a day—up or down—as the stock market changes in a year. Nonetheless, we were continually asked the same question: “What should I read to get the full picture of what’s going on in these markets?” The frequency of this question grew to a clamor as the markets rose through the first half of 2017, and yet information channels remained stubbornly fragmented among Reddit, Twitter, Telegram, Slack, Medium, news sites, and more.

While we recognize the difficulty in covering the *full picture* of the ever-moving cryptoasset markets, we believe